in Tabreez a few months ago, they had been given me by Bahman Meerza and his son, and I should have liked to have kept them, but I was short of money and I got sixty tomauns for them, a very good price; I got another shawl at the no-roze (21*st* March Persian new year) but not a very good one, it is only worth about twenty tomauns. I have not yet sold it and hope not to do so.

My present pay Ts 400 -- (four hundred tomauns) a year is good pay for the country, but it is not paid regularly and I have now long arrears of pay to claim. In fact the government now have no money and they are not likely to have much for some time to come, last years revenues were swallowed up by the late Prime minister and his people, and as in Persia the first instalment of the taxes, are not due until April or May, we can not expect much to come in from the provinces yet; I am in favor with the King and the Prime minister[122] and I do not dispair of getting on well, but at present it is rather up hill work.

We have had some disturbances from the mutiny of three regiments of soldiers now happily finished.

Our minister Col Shiel, has not yet arrived from England, but he is expected in about a month. When he arrives our present Chargé d'affaires, Col Farrant will most likely go home, we shall be sorry to lose him, he is a remarkably good-hearted, hospitable man.

At present I am fixed here, but it is not unlikely that I may get some appointment in the provinces, which I shall try for if I find that I do not make much here. The Shah talks of moving in the summer but I think it probable that want of money may prevent his leaving the neighbourhood of Tehran.

You never told me whether the paterns of Persian silk and cotton goods were worth any thing, and whether they were admired or not. I should like to hear about this.

I was sorry to learn from the newspapers that the cholera had extended its ravages to America. It has I learn, been very slight in London, only about a hundred cases in a week out of a population of two millions, in '35 we lost (deaths) for two days five hundred a day at Tabreez out of a population of certainly not then more than a hundred thousand. In the cholera of '46, seven or eight thousand died in Tabreez and in '47 about half the number. Persia is now thank God free from it.

The former Prime minister now an exile at Kerbelai, has got into some theological disputes with the Mollahs of that place, and has been pelted by the people. His enormous wealth has been confiscated by the crown at least all that was not plundered by the people in the disturbances which succeeded the late king's death.

(To be concluded)

122 Mirza Taki Khan, Amir-i-Nizam, premier 1848–1851.

Generated on 2020-09-16 01:41 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112419
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN